THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ORTHOPEDIC FOLLOW-UP VISIT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 06/10/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Interval History: Two epidural injections with temporary relief only. Completed 36 therapy visits.
Symptoms: Pain 7/10, worsening right leg pain, new weakness of right plantarflexion.
Physical Exam: Right plantarflexion 4/5. Absent right Achilles reflex. Straight leg raise positive at 35 degrees.
Assessment: Lumbar disc displacement with radiculopathy, L5-S1 (M51.17), progressive motor deficit.
Plan: Recommend right L5-S1 microdiscectomy. Surgery scheduled 06/30/2025 at UPMC Mercy.
Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 6 hours as needed #60 (changed from hydrocodone).
Work Status: Temporary total disability (TTD) - off work pending surgery.
Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 06/10/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

UTILIZATION REVIEW REQUEST - REQUEST FOR AUTHORIZATION

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Request Date: 06/11/2025 Requesting Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Requested Treatment: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy (CPT 63030) with 1 day inpatient stay.
Diagnosis: Lumbar disc displacement with radiculopathy L5-S1 (M51.17).
Clinical Justification: Progressive motor deficit, concordant MRI and EMG, failed 5 months of conservative care.
Response Requested By: 06/25/2025

LODESTAR UTILIZATION REVIEW SERVICES | Physician Review

UTILIZATION REVIEW DETERMINATION LETTER

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Determination Date: 06/21/2025

Request: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy (CPT 63030).

Determination: Certified. Criteria met: radiculopathy with concordant imaging and progressive motor deficit.

Reviewer: Helen Park, MD - Orthopedic Surgery

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

UPMC MERCY | Department of Surgery | Pittsburgh, PA

OPERATIVE REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Surgery: 06/30/2025 Location: UPMC Mercy, OR 4

Preoperative Diagnosis: Right L5-S1 disc herniation with S1 radiculopathy (M51.17).

Postoperative Diagnosis: Same.

Procedure Performed: Right L5-S1 hemilaminotomy and microdiscectomy (CPT 63030).

Surgeon: Victoria Chen, MD Assistant: Owen Grant, PA-C

Anesthesia: General endotracheal anesthesia.

Indication for Surgery: Progressive right S1 motor deficit with concordant MRI and EMG despite conservative care.

Intraoperative Findings: Sequestered disc fragment compressing the right S1 nerve root; root decompressed.

Implants: None. Estimated Blood Loss: 40 mL. Specimens: Disc fragments to pathology.

Complications: None.

Postoperative Plan: Discharge postoperative day 1. No lifting over 10 lb for 6 weeks. Begin physical therapy at 3 weeks.

Surgeon Signature: Victoria Chen, MD Date: 06/30/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 07/14/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.
Postoperative Diagnosis: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17).
Symptoms: Back pain 4/10. Right leg pain resolved.
Incision: Well healed, no signs of infection.
Assessment: Recovering after microdiscectomy.
Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 8 hours as needed #45 refilled.
Work Status: Temporary total disability (TTD) - remain off work.
Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 07/14/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 08/18/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.
Postoperative Diagnosis: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17).
Symptoms: Back pain 4/10. Right leg pain resolved.
PT/Rehab: Start physical therapy 2 times per week for 8 weeks (16 visits).
Physical Exam: Strength 5/5. Straight leg raise negative.
Assessment: Recovering after microdiscectomy.
Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 8 hours as needed #45 refilled.
Work Status: Temporary total disability (TTD) continues.
Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 08/18/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 10/06/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.

Postoperative Diagnosis: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17).

Symptoms: Back pain 5/10. Right leg pain intermittent 3/10.

Physical Exam: Strength 5/5. Straight leg raise negative.

Assessment: Persistent mechanical low back pain; functional plateau.

Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 8 hours as needed #45 refilled.

Work Status: Modified duty - no lifting over 20 lb, no repetitive bending, maximum 6 hours per day.

Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 10/06/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 12/08/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.
Postoperative Diagnosis: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17).
Symptoms: Back pain 5/10. Right leg pain intermittent 3/10.
Interval History: Repeat MRI lumbar spine performed 02/02/2026 at Allegheny Diagnostic Imaging was reviewed.
Imaging: Repeat MRI 02/02/2026 shows postoperative changes and L5-S1 disc degeneration without recurrent herniation.
Physical Exam: Strength 5/5. Straight leg raise negative.
Assessment: Persistent mechanical low back pain; functional plateau.
Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 8 hours as needed #45 refilled.
Work Status: Modified duty - no lifting over 20 lb, no repetitive bending.
Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 12/08/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 03/02/2026 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.
Postoperative Diagnosis: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17).
Symptoms: Back pain 5/10. Right leg pain intermittent 3/10.
Physical Exam: Strength 5/5. Straight leg raise negative.
Assessment: Persistent mechanical low back pain; functional plateau.
Medications: Discontinue oxycodone; tramadol 50 mg as needed.
Work Status: Modified duty per FCE - light duty, lifting up to 20 lb occasionally and 10 lb frequently.
MMI: Patient has not yet reached maximum medical improvement. Anticipate MMI in approximately 4 months (08/2026) after the requested fusion is decided.
Plan: Request authorization for L5-S1 lumbar fusion (CPT 22612) for discogenic pain.
Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 03/02/2026

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.